Nova Southeastern University
Graduate School of Computer and Information Sciences

Course Syllabus

MMIS/MCIS 671, Decision Support Systems, 3 credits

Term code 201330 (Masters Winter 2013), January 7, 2013 – April 28, 2013, online

Instructor:
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Biography
Dr. Michael Reid brings to The Graduate School of Computer and Information Sciences more than 17 years of Information Systems management experience, as well as prior teaching and research experience (Loma Linda University, California; Northern Caribbean University and West Indies Union, Jamaica). He received his MS degree in Software Engineering from Andrews University, Berrien Springs, Michigan (1998), and Ph.D. in Information Systems from Nova Southeastern University, Ft. Lauderdale, Florida (2009). His most recent publication in the Journal of Internet Banking and Commerce is available here. In addition, Dr. Reid serves as the Assistant to the Editor-in-Chief and International Review Board Member for the International Journal of Doctoral Studies (IJDS), and is a member of The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE). His current research interests are: decision support systems, users' perceptions and acceptance of information systems, cognitive aspects of information systems, effectiveness of information systems, security and ethical issues of information systems, and software engineering.

Class Location and Format: online

Class Hours: not applicable.

Class Website: Blackboard

Course Description:
This course examines concepts of decision support in both automated and non-automated environments. The focus is on application of decision theory, analytical modeling, and simulation techniques to solve organizational problems. Group Decision Support Systems, Executive Information Systems, and Expert Systems are also discussed. Case studies of existing systems are used to reinforce concepts discussed in class. A major component of the course is a project entailing the design, implementation, and evaluation of a Decision Support System.

Required Textbook(s):
Title: Decision Support and Business Intelligence Systems (required)
Author: Efraim Turban, Ramesh Sharda & Dursun Delen
ISBN: 9780136107293
Edition: 9th
Publication Year: 2010
Publisher: Prentice Hall

Learning Outcomes:
After successful completion of the course students should be able to:
1. Articulate the role of decision support systems and expert systems in organizations.
2. Apply decision theory and other management science techniques to analyze problems.
3. Formulate and use analytical models for organizational problem solving.
4. Design and develop decision support systems and expert systems.

Schedule

January 7 – April 28, 2013

Class	Topic	Assignment
	January	
	Decision Support and Business Intelligence	
Week 1 01/07– 01/13	Decision Support Systems and Business Intelligence	• Read Ch 1 • Live Classroom Session 1 on January 10 at 8 p.m. EST
	Computerized Decision Support	
Week 2 01/14- 01/20	Decision Making, Systems, Modeling, and Support	• Read Ch 2 • Quiz #1 – Chapter 1 & 2 • Article Review #1
Jan 21	**** M. L. KING HOLIDAY ****	
Week 3 01/21- 01/27	Decision Support Systems Concepts, Methodologies, and Technologies	• Read Ch 3 • Live Classroom Session 2, January 24 at 8 p.m. EST • Forum #1
Week 4 01/28- 02/03	Modeling and Analysis	• Read Ch 4 • Quiz #2 – Chapters 3 & 4 • Homework #1
	February	
	Business Intelligence	
Week 5 02/04- 02/10	Data Mining and Business Intelligence	• Read Ch 5
Week 6 02/11- 02/17	Artificial Neural Networks and data Mining	• Read Ch 6 • Quiz #3 – Chapters 5 & 6
Week7 02/18- 02/24	Text and Web Mining	• Read Ch 7 • Article Review #2 • Live Classroom Session 3, February 21 at 8 p.m. EST
Week 8 02/25- 03/03	Data Warehousing	• Read Ch 8 • Quiz #4 – Chapters 7 & 8 • Homework #2 • Forum #2

	March	
Week 9 03/04-03/10	Business Performance Management	• Read Ch 9
	Collaboration, Communication, Group Support Systems, and Knowledge Management	
Week 10 03/11-03/17	Collaborative Computer-Supported Technologies and Group Support Systems	• Read Ch 10 • Quiz #5 – Chapters 9 & 10 • Article Review #3 • Forum #3
Week 11 03/18-03/24	Knowledge Management	• Read Ch 11 • Live Classroom Session 4, March 21 at 8 p.m. EST
	Intelligent Systems	
Week 12 03/25-03/31	Artificial Intelligence and Expert Systems	• Read Ch 12 • Quiz #6 – Chapters 11 & 12 • Homework #3
	April	
Week 13 04/01 04/07	Advanced Intelligence Systems	• Read Ch 13
	Implementing Decision Support Systems and Business Intelligence	
Week 14 04/08-04/14	Management Support Systems: Emerging Trends and Impacts	• Read Ch 14 • Quiz #7 – Chapters 13 & 14 • Forum #4
Week 15 04/15-04/21	Complete work on final project	• Article Review #4 • Live Classroom Session 5, April 18 at 8 p.m. EST
Week 16 04/22-04/28	Complete work on final project	• **Final project**

Instruction Methods and Tools:
This course will utilize Blackboard as the delivery tool. All assignments, quizzes, journal summaries, and class discussions will take place in the Blackboard site assigned to this course. The certificate of authorship page should be completed and included with ALL assignment submitted. This can be found at: scis.nova.edu -> for current students -> documents

Assignments:
There are three (3) homework assignments, four (4) article reviews, four (4) discussion forums, and one (1) project.

Homework Assignments:
There are three (3) homework assignments. See assignment attached in Blackboard. The three assignments are worth 30% of your final grade (10% each).

Project:
Class project is attached. The project is worth 25% of your final grade.

Forum Assignments:
There are four (4) discussion forum assignments. For each forum, an application question will be posted by the instructor. You are required to post at least a one paragraph response to the question as well as your feedback to one of your peer posting. As much as possible, your arguments must be supported with reference/s. Discussion forums are worth 10% of your final grade.

Article Reviews Assignments:
There are four (4) article review assignments. Each article review assignment consists of two parts:

- **Part one** - is a review of an article from Teradata Student Network or a refereed journal that is relevant to **any ONE (1)** of the chapters under review. You must integrate in the last paragraph of this report, the findings from this article with the information presented in the text.
- **Part two** - provide the answers to the end of chapter application case for any **ONE (1)** of the chapters under review.

Article reviews are worth 15% of your final grade.

Quizzes:
There will be seven (7) quizzes throughout the term. Quizzes will be based on the textbook reading of the corresponding chapters. See "Course Outline & Calendar" for additional information. The quizzes will be done via Blackboard and will be available for students for seven (7) days (Monday to Sunday). Each quiz consist of 40 multiple choice questions and is scheduled for two and a half hours. **No makeup will be allowed on quizzes**. Quizzes are worth 20% of your final grade.

Grading Criteria:
The final grade will be determined by a weighted average of the following:

Component	Weight
Class Participation (class discussions, forums)	10%
Quizzes	20%
Project	25%
Homework Assignments (No.1 to No.3)	30%
Article reviews (No.1 to No.4)	15%
Total	100%

Grading Scale:

Score	Grade	Score	Grade	Score	Grade
93-100	A	83-86	B	73-76	C
90-92	A-	80-82	B-	70-72	C-
87-89	B+	77-79	C+	Below 70	F

Class/Course Rules:

- Mutual respect and courtesy.
- Professional quality in the organization, completeness, neatness, and timeliness of any material submitted will be expected.
- **Late assignments will not be accepted!** However, the professor realizes that exceptional situations (such as justified emergencies or medical situations) do occur. In such cases, please inform your professor via e-mail to obtain special permission for late submission, **prior to the deadline**.
- A student may not do additional work or repeat an examination to raise a final grade.
- All papers and assignments should include a certificate of authorship signed by the student.
- The professor is not obligated to communicate with students via e-mail or telephone about the course or assignments after final grades have been submitted. However, official Challenge of Course Grade and Student Grievance Procedure, as outlined in the graduate catalog, will be processed.
- Students should be aware that any submitted work for this course may be subjected to detection of breach of copyright.
- All work should be done per APA format (see details below).

Bibliography:

IS Journals related to DSS

The following sites contain links to journals related to DSS:

INFORMS PubsOnLine: http://www.informs.org/Pubs/

- Decision Analysis
- Information Systems Research
- Interfaces
- Journal on Computing
- Management Science
- Manufacturing & Service
- Operations Management
- Marketing Science
- Mathematics of OR
- Operations Research
- Organization Science
- Transportation Science

Decision Support Systems:
http://www.elsevier.com/wps/find/journaldescription.cws_home/505540/description

IEEE and ACM publications often carry articles related to techniques used in DSS.

DSS Resources Page: http://dssresources.com/

School and University Policies and Procedures:

Students must comply with the policies published in the school's Graduate Catalog and the NSU Student Handbook, some of which are included or referenced below. The catalog is at http://www.scis.nova.edu/documents/catalog.pdf The handbook is at http://www.nova.edu/cwis/studentaffairs/forms/ustudenthandbook.pdf

1. Standards of Academic Integrity For the university-wide policy on academic standards, see the section Code of Student Conduct and Academic Responsibility in the NSU Student Handbook. Also see the section Student Misconduct in the GSCIS catalog. Each student is responsible for maintaining academic integrity and intellectual honesty in his or her academic work. It is the policy of the school that each student must:

- Submit his or her own work, not that of another person
- Not falsify data or records (including admission materials and academic work)
- Not engage in cheating (e.g., giving or receiving help during examinations; acquiring and/or transmitting test questions prior to an examination; or using unauthorized materials, such as notes, during an examination)
- Not receive or give aid on assigned work that requires independent effort
- Properly credit the words or ideas of others according to accepted standards for professional publications (see the next section Crediting Words or Ideas)
- Not use or consult paper writing services, software coding services, or similar services for the purpose of obtaining assistance in the preparation of materials to be submitted for course assignments or for theses or dissertations.
- Not commit plagiarism (Merriam-*Webster's Collegiate Dictionary* (2004) defines plagiarism as "stealing or passing off ideas or words of another as one's own" and "the use of a created production without crediting the source.") (see Crediting Words or Ideas below)

Crediting Words or Ideas

When using the exact words from another work, quotation marks must be used for short quotations (fewer than 40 words), and block quotation style must be used for longer quotations. In either case, a proper citation must also be provided. Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association, Sixth Edition, contains standards and examples on quotation methods.

When paraphrasing (summarizing, or rewriting) the words or ideas from another work, a proper citation must be provided. (Publication Manual of the American Psychological Association, Sixth Edition contains standards and examples on citation methods. The New Shorter Oxford English Dictionary (1993) defines paraphrase as "An expression in other words, usually fuller and clearer, of the sense of a written or spoken passage or text…Express the meaning (of a word, phrase, passage, or work) in other words, usually with the object of clarification…". Changing word order, deleting words, or substituting synonyms is not acceptable paraphrasing—it is plagiarism, even when properly cited.

Rather than make changes of this nature, the source should be quoted as written.

Original Work

Assignments, exams, projects, papers, theses, dissertations, etc., must be the original work of the student. Original work may include the thoughts and words of others, but such thoughts or words must be identified using quotation marks or indentation and must properly identify the source (see the previous section Crediting Words or Ideas). At all times, students are expected to comply with the school's accepted citation practice and policy.

Work is not original when it has been submitted previously by the author or by anyone else for academic credit. Work is not original when it has been copied or partially copied from any other source, including another student, unless such copying is acknowledged by the person submitting the work for the credit at the time the work is being submitted, or unless copying, sharing, or joint authorship is an express part of the assignment. Exams and tests are original work when no unauthorized aid is given, received, or used before or during the course of the examination, reexamination, and/or remediation.

2. Writing Skills

Students must demonstrate proficiency in the use of the English language. Grammatical errors, spelling errors, and writing that fails to express ideas clearly will affect their grades and the completion of their academic programs. The faculty will not provide remedial help concerning grammatical errors or other writing difficulties. It is the student's responsibility to proofread and edit his or her work, which, in both form and content, should be letter-perfect. Work that is not properly edited will be rejected.

3. Disabilities and ADA

NSU complies with the American with Disabilities Act (ADA). The university's detailed policy on disabilities is contained in the NSU Student Handbook. Student requests for accommodation based on ADA will be considered on an individual basis. Students with disabilities should discuss their needs with NSU's ADA Coordinator before the commencement of classes if possible.

4. Communication by Email

Students must use their NSU email accounts when sending email to faculty and staff and must clearly identify their names and other appropriate information, e.g., course or program. When communicating with students via email, faculty and staff members will send mail only to NSU email accounts using NSU-recognized usernames. Students who forward their NSU-generated email to other email accounts do so at their own risk. GSCIS uses various course management tools that use private internal email systems. Students enrolled in courses using these tools should check both the private internal email system and NSU's regular email system. NSU offers students web-based email access. Students are encouraged to check their NSU email account and their course management email daily.

5. The Temporary Grade of Incomplete (I)

The temporary grade of Incomplete (I) will be granted only in cases of extreme hardship. Students do not have a right to an incomplete, which may be granted only when there is evidence of just cause. A student desiring an incomplete must submit a written appeal to the course professor at least two weeks prior to the end of the term. In the appeal, the student must: (1) provide a rationale; (2) demonstrate that he/she has been making a sincere effort to complete the assignments during the term; and (3) explain how all the possibilities to complete the assignments on time have been exhausted. Should the course professor agree, an incomplete contract will be prepared by the student and signed by both student and professor. The incomplete contract must contain a description of the work to be completed and a timetable. The completion period should be the shortest possible. The completion date will not typically extend beyond 30 days from the last day of the term for master's courses or beyond 60 days from the last day of the term for doctoral courses. The incomplete contract will accompany the submission of the professor's final grade roster to the program office. The program office will monitor each incomplete contract. When the incomplete contract ends the course professor will assign a grade based upon the work completed. No student may graduate with an I on his or her record.

6. Grade Policy Regarding Withdrawals

Course withdrawal requests must be submitted to the program office in writing by the student. Requests for withdrawal must be received by the program office by the withdrawal deadline (see dates in the academic calendar in the catalog and program brochures or websites). Withdrawals sent by email must be sent from the student's assigned NSU email account. Requests for withdrawal received after 11:59 p.m. EST on the withdrawal deadline date will not be accepted. Failure to attend class or participate in course activities will not automatically drop or withdraw a student from the class or the university. Students who have not withdrawn by the withdrawal deadline will receive letter grades that reflect their performance in the course. When a withdrawal request is approved, the transcript will show a grade of W (Withdrawn) for the course. Students with four withdrawals will be dismissed from the program. Depending on the date of withdrawal, the student may be eligible for a partial refund (see the appropriate catalog section Refund Policy Regarding Withdrawals).

7. Acceptable Use of Computing Resources

Students must comply with the university's Policy on Acceptable Use of Computing Resources (see NSU Student Handbook).

8. Academic Progress, Grade Requirements, and Academic Standing

Students must be familiar with the school's policies, which are contained in its catalog.

9. Student Research Involving Human Subjects

Students must be familiar with the university's policy (see paragraph in catalog).

10. Responsibility for Payment of Tuition and Fees

Once registered, students are personally responsible for the payment of their tuition and fees. Returned checks, cancelled credit cards, employer or agency refusal to pay, ineligibility for financial aid, and other reasons for non-payment may result in a direct bill to the student, and/or referral to a collection agency.

Payment and refund policies are based on the view that a student registering for a class is reserving a place in that class and that tuition and fees cover the opportunity to secure that place in the class. Since no other person can purchase that place, the student is responsible for the tuition and fees associated with it. Simply not attending does not constitute a reason for non-payment.